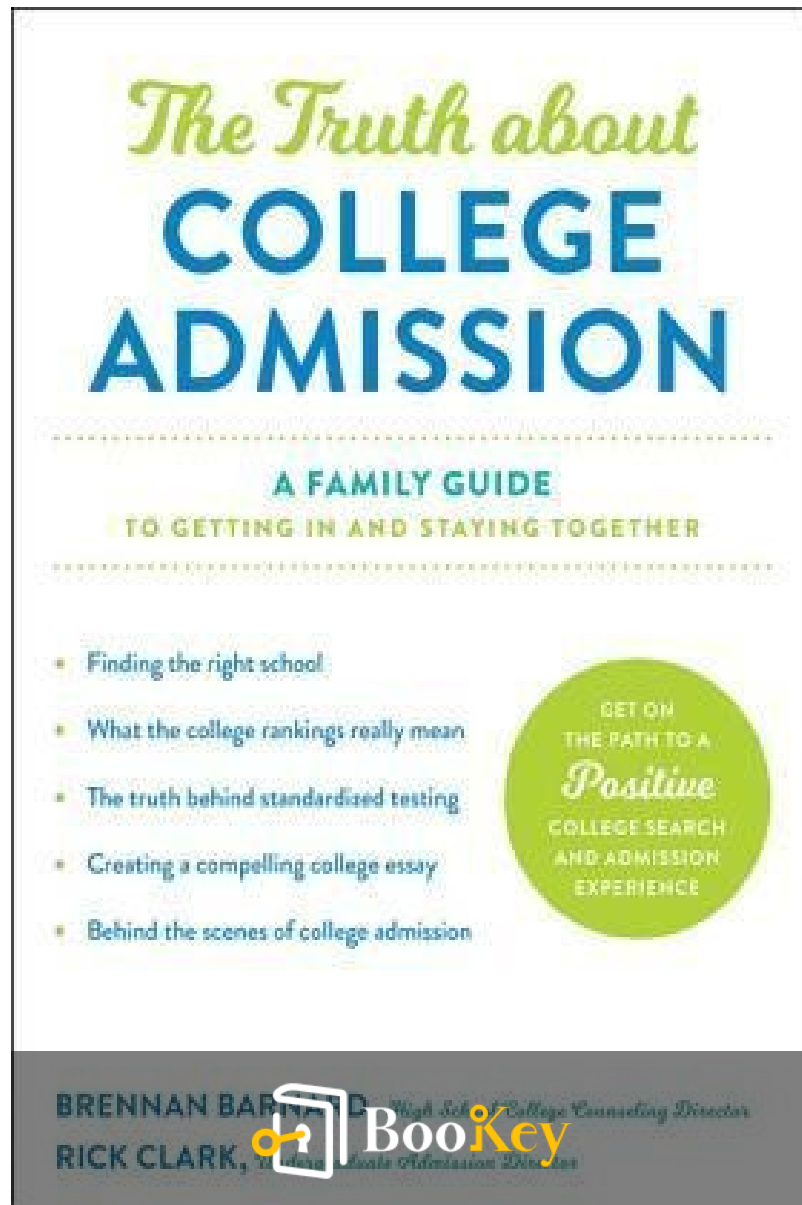


The Truth about College Admission PDF

Brennan E Barnard



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The Truth about College Admission

Navigating College Admission: Your Family's
Essential Guide to Success

Written by Bookey

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About the book

Navigating the college admission process can be daunting for families, but "The Truth about College Admission" simplifies this journey. Written by a seasoned high school counselor and a college admission director, this comprehensive guide offers essential insights for every stage of the college search and application experience. Whether you're just beginning to explore campuses or feeling overwhelmed by deadlines and choices, you'll find practical advice, strategic tips, and reassuring guidance throughout the book. From crafting standout applications to understanding what colleges seek in candidates, each chapter equips families with the knowledge they need to make informed decisions. Engaging sections like "Try This," "Talk about This," and "Check In" foster open dialogue, helping to alleviate stress and transform this milestone into a shared adventure. This essential resource empowers families to approach college admissions with confidence and clarity, making it a valuable companion on the path to college acceptance.

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About the author

Brennan E. Barnard is an esteemed educator and author with a deep commitment to guiding students and families through the complexities of the college admissions process. With years of experience as a college counselor at a reputable independent school, Barnard combines his extensive knowledge of educational practices with a compassionate approach to student development. He is dedicated to demystifying the admissions landscape, emphasizing authenticity and personal growth over mere accolades and statistics. Through his writing, including "The Truth about College Admission," Barnard seeks to empower students to embrace their individuality and make informed decisions about their educational journeys, fostering a more equitable and holistic approach to college admissions.

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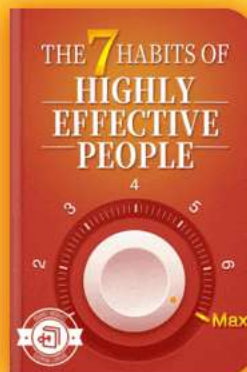
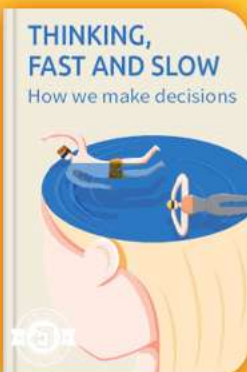


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Summary Content List

Chapter 1 : Why Are You Going to College?

Chapter 2 : Remapping the Admission Landscape

Chapter 3 : Wedges of College Admission

Chapter 4 : Creating a College List

Chapter 5 : The College Visit

Chapter 6 : Admission Factors I: What Are Colleges Looking for Academically?

Chapter 7 : Admission Factors II: What Are Colleges Looking for Outside the Classroom?

Chapter 8 : Admission Decisions

Chapter 9 : Making Your College Choice

Chapter 10 : Closing Letters

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Chapter 1 Summary : Why Are You Going to College?



CHAPTER 1: Why Are You Going to College?

Introduction to the Issue

The chapter begins by illustrating the emotional turmoil surrounding college admissions through a story about a family with a high-achieving daughter who was denied admission to Georgia Tech. The father expresses frustration over the denial, citing his daughter's excellent academic performance and extracurricular involvement. The admission officer reflects on the competitive nature of college

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admissions and the difficulty in conveying these realities to disappointed families.

Understanding College Admissions

- College admissions are highly competitive, with many applicants boasting stellar grades and achievements.
- Decisions are not solely based on academic metrics; they involve a holistic review considering various factors such as institutional fit and diversity.
- The personal nature of college admissions often leads to parents expressing their distress, reflecting their love and investment in their children's future.

The Emotional Impact

- The process can elicit strong emotional responses, including frustration and despair for families.
- Many families react by questioning the fairness and transparency of admission processes, leading to strained communication with admissions offices.
- It's essential to understand that a denial can reflect a myriad of contextual factors, not just individual merit.

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The Role of Family

- The drive for college success is deeply tied to familial love and expectations.
- Parents often become intensely involved, sometimes leading to them acting irrationally in their pursuit of understanding admission decisions.
- Despite the pressures, it's crucial for parents and students to remain united and supportive through the admissions journey.

Transforming the Experience

- The chapter emphasizes the importance of reframing the college search as a family experience rather than a competition.
- Students are encouraged to explore personal motivations for attending college, focusing on self-discovery about their goals and aspirations.
- The admissions experience should be viewed as an opportunity for growth, vision, and family bonding, rather than as a mere transactional process.

The Cornerstone Question

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- The primary question should not be “Where do you want to go to college?” but rather “Why are you going to college?”
- Understanding the ‘why’ encourages deeper introspection on desires, goals, and suitable environments for personal and academic growth.
- This foundational question helps guide students in making informed choices about their future and enhances their overall college experience.

Conclusion and Reflection

- The chapter invites students and families to rethink their approach to college admissions.
- It encourages open dialogue about personal expectations, motivations, and the alignment of goals.
- The chapter ends with reflective questions for families to consider, promoting discussion on motivations, school selections, and the collective journey through the admissions process.

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Chapter 2 Summary : Remapping the Admission Landscape



CHAPTER 2: Remapping the Admission Landscape

Introduction to College Considerations

- Importance of reflecting on the purpose of attending college.
- Encourage evaluating preferred experiences, community dynamics, and classroom environments.
- Emphasize family support in the college journey.

Engaging with a Quiz

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- Present a quiz related to the number of U.S. colleges and their admission rates to engage the reader's curiosity.

Anecdotal Illustration

- Share a story about a family outing, where the author humorously illustrates a child's unique perspective, highlighting the need to “look beyond what you see.”

Looking Beyond What You See

- The diversity of the college landscape is emphasized, noting various statistics about institutions in the U.S.
- Attendees should maintain a mindset of possibility and openness to a wide array of colleges.

Understanding Admission Statistics

- Clarify common assumptions about college admissions, specifically the misconception that selective schools dominate.
- Reiterate that most colleges welcome a broad range of applicants and that many remain open for admissions even

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late in the cycle.

Value of Perspective

- Encourage families to re-evaluate their understanding of the higher education landscape to discover potential fits.
- The chapter prompts readers to identify and discuss the colleges they are familiar with to expand their perspective.

College Search as a Two-Way Street

- Explain how colleges actively search for students and the financial implications of college recruitment strategies.
- Describe the process of how colleges use standardized tests to identify prospective students.

Case Study: Example College

- Provide an example of a college's specific enrollment goals and the strategies used to identify and recruit suitable candidates.
- Explain the significance of data in developing outreach strategies to meet institutional priorities.

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Takeaway Lessons

1.

Think like a dean

: Broaden the scope of college searches to explore options beyond initial thoughts.

2.

Check that box

: Opt in during standardized testing to receive information and broaden choices.

3.

Segment your search

: Organize recruitment materials and categorize them based on interest.

4.

Work the funnel

: Engage with colleges that reach out to you, showing interest and moving through the admission funnel.

Broaden Your Perspective

- Suggest using visual aids like the book "Zoom" to illustrate the concept of looking beyond initial impressions in the college search.

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Extra Credit Activity

- Encouragement to listen to the song “Little Boxes” to frame the college search experience.

Discussion Prompts

- Reflect on challenges in maintaining an open mind during the college search.
- Identify local factors that may limit college options.
- Discuss excitement about the potential college experience and re-evaluate interest lists.

Check-in

- Encourage reevaluation of family alignment in the college search.

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Chapter 3 Summary : Wedges of College Admission

Wedges of College Admission

In Chapter 3 of "The Truth about College Admission," Brennan E. Barnard draws parallel comparisons between the college admission process and the home buying experience, highlighting the stress and confusion both entail. The chapter identifies four primary wedges that can cause division within families during college admissions and provides tools to foster unity.

WEDGE #1: TIME

The constant and unintentional integration of college discussions into everyday life can create tension. To avoid this, families should designate a specific time each week to discuss college matters to preserve relational dynamics and minimize interruptions.

House Rules:

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- Parents should limit their perspectives to current information and not reflect outdated stereotypes.
- Students should approach discussions ready to contribute meaningfully.

By doing this, misunderstandings can be mitigated, and the focus can shift from nagging to constructive engagement.

WEDGE #2: COMMUNICATION

Public discussions about college applications can lead to unwarranted speculation and anxiety. Students are encouraged to build a trusted "College Support Team," while parents should avoid sharing details about their child's college journey with others. Maintaining privacy helps in fostering trust during this personal experience.

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Chapter 4 Summary : Creating a College List

Creating a College List

Introduction

Creating a college list is a vital part of the college admission process, encouraging exploration of a child's interests and desires. It emphasizes the importance of letting students take ownership of their decisions in this journey.

Understanding the Process

The college admission experience is likened to a helicopter tour rather than a plane ride, urging families to focus on exploration rather than just reaching a specific destination. This perspective change promotes a more enjoyable journey where the process is as valuable as the outcome.

Control in the College Search

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Listen It

Families can control two-thirds of the college admission experience: where to visit and apply, and which school to attend.

Advice for Freshmen and Sophomores

In early high school, students should focus on being engaged and authentic, participating in activities they genuinely enjoy, while avoiding excessive pressure related to college preparation. They should reflect on personal interests and explore opportunities, while keeping college in mind as they develop.

Junior Year Strategies

Focus on understanding the differences between needs and wants in a college—separating essential criteria from desirable ones, such as location, size, majors, and campus culture. This clarity will assist in narrowing down choices effectively.

Factors to Consider

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-

Location

: Identify preferred settings (urban/rural) and assess the importance of distance from home.

-

Size

: Consider personal comfort with small or large campus environments and the implications for educational experience.

-

Programs

: Research colleges' offerings, particularly for intended majors, understanding policies on changing majors.

-

People

: Reflect on desired peer groups and campus culture, including diversity and alumni networks.

-

Extracurricular Activities

: Think about involvement beyond academics, including clubs, sports, and internships.

-

Cost

: Discuss finances openly to understand financial aid options

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and budget considerations.

-

Selectivity

: Maintain a balanced list incorporating a range of selectivity, ensuring broad options without fixating solely on prestigious institutions.

Research and Campus Visits

Utilize online resources and tools to research colleges, and prioritize campus visits to gather firsthand insights. Engage with admission representatives at fairs and school visits, asking specific questions.

Finalizing the College List

In the senior year's late summer and early fall, evaluate the remaining schools to ensure they align with personal interests and goals. Aim for a balanced list that includes reach, target, and likely schools, focusing on excitement and genuine interest in each.

Engagement and Communication

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Encourage open communication between students and parents about expectations and outside influences affecting college choices. Share and discuss individual college lists, emphasizing values and priorities.

Conclusion

Successfully creating a college list involves personal reflection, exploration, and open dialogue among family members. It's crucial to trust one's intuition and ensure that the final college selection resonates with individual aspirations and values.

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Chapter 5 Summary : The College Visit

Chapter 5: The College Visit

Overview

In this chapter, the author emphasizes the importance of college visits in helping students and parents understand their needs and preferences when choosing a college. It encourages families to view these visits as adventures filled with exploration and connections.

Why Visit

Visiting diverse colleges allows students to differentiate between their needs and wants. Experiences on campus offer invaluable insights that cannot be gleaned from online resources alone. Furthermore, demonstrating interest by visiting campuses can positively influence admissions decisions.

When to Visit

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There are no strict rules for when to start campus tours; the key is readiness and willingness to engage. It is most beneficial to visit during school sessions to observe campus culture fully. Planning ahead is crucial, especially during busy periods such as summer or holiday breaks.

How to Visit

The author recommends using college websites for visit information and to inquire about experiences like sitting in on a class. Families should space visits appropriately to avoid exhaustion and allow for reflection.

Critical Questions

The chapter outlines essential questions to ask during visits, including inquiries about campus culture, academic structures, retention rates, and graduation rates. The goal is to gather comprehensive information from multiple sources to formulate a well-rounded view of the institution.

A Variety of Voices

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When visiting, students should seek responses from a wide range of individuals—students, faculty, and staff—to gain various perspectives on campus life. Questions that engage deeper insights can reveal much about the school's culture and community.

Be Prepared

Developing a list of thoughtful questions can enhance the visit's effectiveness. Engaging with current students and faculty beyond formal tours can provide a clearer picture of the college experience.

Veteran Advice

Former visitors recommend that students maintain an open mind, focus on personal impressions, and be proactive in seeking more authentic experiences outside of guided tours. Parents are encouraged to support their children in forming their own opinions.

Creative Approaches

The chapter suggests transforming visits into scavenger hunts

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to encourage interaction and exploration, enhancing the overall experience and retention of information.

Check In

Families are urged to communicate and assess their understandings after visits, ensuring everyone is aligned on goals and impressions as they move forward in the college search process.

Overall, Chapter 5 emphasizes the significance of campus visits and proactive engagement in making informed college decisions.

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Chapter 6 Summary : Admission Factors

I: What Are Colleges Looking for Academically?

Admission Factors: What Are Colleges Looking for Academically?

Chapter 6 discusses the factors colleges consider during the admission process, focusing on applications, course choices, standardized testing, and the methods of evaluating candidates.

Application Submission Methods

Students can submit college applications through three primary methods: institutional-specific applications, the Common Application, and the Coalition for College application. Each college may have different preferences or requirements for these methods. The Common Application allows students to apply to multiple colleges with one standardized form, while the Coalition for College aims to support less resourced students through various online tools.

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Application Deadlines and Types

There are several admission types:

1.

Rolling Admission

: Applies anytime after the application opens, with decisions made as applications are received.

2.

Early Decision (ED)

: A binding option where students commit to one school if accepted.

3.

Early Action (EA)

: Non-binding, allowing students to apply early without the commitment to attend.

4.

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Alex Walk

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Chapter 7 Summary : Admission Factors II: What Are Colleges Looking for Outside the Classroom?

Chapter 7 Summary: Admission Factors II - What Are Colleges Looking for Outside the Classroom?

Overview

In this chapter, the author discusses the qualitative, nonacademic factors that colleges consider during the admission process. These factors include extracurricular involvement, impact on the community, and personal influence, highlighting the importance of presenting a well-rounded narrative in applications.

Extracurricular Involvement and Impact

Colleges seek to understand a student's engagement beyond academics, focusing on how students spend their time outside of school. Key considerations include:

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-

What Is This Student Involved With?

Admissions committees look for meaningful involvement that reflects students' interests and values rather than the sheer volume of activities.

-

What Is This Student Investing In?

It's a misconception that students must be "well-rounded"; instead, depth in a couple of activities can be equally valued. Committees appreciate commitment and deep engagement in fewer activities.

-

What Impact Has This Student Made?

Students are assessed based on their contributions, highlighting the difference between mere participation and making a substantial impact. Quality of involvement matters more than quantity.

-

How Has This Student Influenced Others?

Admission committees want to see how students will complement and enhance the campus community through their commitments and experiences.

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Practical Tips for Application

When completing applications:

- Distill your extracurricular involvement to highlight significant activities that tell your story, focusing on depth and engagement.
- Use clear examples to articulate your impact—how you've contributed and what you've learned.
- Don't inflate your activities with trivial details; succinctly communicate relevance.

Essays and Short Answers

Essays help differentiate applicants. Key points for effective writing include:

- Start strong to capture attention; don't restate prompts.
- Focus on authentic personal narratives rather than just academic achievements.
- Show character and self-awareness, answering "why" beneath the surface of your experiences.

Additional Information Section

Use this section to provide context for unique situations or

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significant challenges faced during high school, enhancing your application's narrative without making excuses.

Interviews

If offered, college interviews are significant opportunities.

Prepare by:

- Researching the institution thoroughly.
- Asking insightful questions that demonstrate genuine interest.
- Practicing conversation skills to engage naturally with interviewers.

Letters of Recommendation

Choose recommenders who can provide meaningful insights into your character and growth, rather than simply highlighting achievements. Effective letters should present a nuanced perspective of your capabilities, reflecting genuine enthusiasm for your potential.

Conclusion

Understanding the multifaceted factors that colleges consider

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outside academic performance can help students strategically approach their applications. By reflecting on involvement, crafting authentic narratives, and preparing thoroughly for interviews and recommendations, applicants can create compelling cases for admission.

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Chapter 8 Summary : Admission Decisions

Admission Decisions

The Complexity of College Admissions

This chapter explores the complexities of college admission decisions, drawing parallels to the subjective nature of judgment in high-stakes environments. It emphasizes that the holistic review process is inherently human, subjective, and imperfect, often leading to unpredictable outcomes that cannot be easily understood by applicants.

Understanding the Admission Landscape

Readers have learned about the wide array of college options available, the mechanics of supply and demand that influence admission rates, and the growing trend of holistic reviews that encompass more than just academic metrics.

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The Imperfect Nature of Holistic Review

The chapter highlights that holistic admissions processes are subjective and lack fairness, with admissions counselors making nuanced decisions amidst high competition. It addresses common sentiments of frustration from applicants who feel their qualifications were overlooked.

Institutional Mission and Admission

It outlines that fulfilling a college's institutional mission is a key driving factor behind admission decisions. Each college aims to recruit students who align with their mission, which influences the selection process significantly. Understanding this aspect can clarify why applicants with similar profiles may receive different decisions.

Impact of Geography and Institutional Changes

Geographical considerations can affect admission outcomes, especially in state universities. Changes in a college's mission or academic offerings can also shift the applicant pool and modify admission criteria, further demonstrating that admission decisions are influenced by factors beyond the

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applicant's control.

Navigating Admission Outcomes

The chapter categorizes the possible outcomes of college applications: defer, wait list, deny, and admit, providing strategic advice on how to handle each scenario:

-

Defer:

A deferral indicates that a student is under consideration but the college wants more information. Students should use this time to maintain strong academic performance and consider additional applications.

-

Wait List:

Being wait-listed can be frustrating. Students should accept their spot on the waitlist, deposit at another institution, and communicate continued interest to the college while preparing for the likelihood they may not be pulled from the list.

-

Deny:

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A denial can be tough to process. Students are encouraged to acknowledge their feelings, understand it does not define their worth, and focus on applying to additional schools with higher admit rates.

-

Admit:

For those who are accepted, it's crucial to celebrate responsibly, remain humble, and adhere to the institution's expectations as they prepare for enrollment.

Pledge to Navigate the Admissions Process

The chapter concludes with a light-hearted pledge for students and parents, emphasizing the importance of realistic expectations and emotional support throughout the admission process.

Discussion Points

Readers are encouraged to reflect on how the mission statements of prospective colleges align with their personal values and how to prepare for various admissions decisions, while checking in on family dynamics related to the college search experience.

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Chapter 9 Summary : Making Your College Choice

CHAPTER 9 Making Your College Choice

Introduction

Choosing a college is a significant decision, paralleling the excitement and paralysis of choosing candy in a shop. Students are often overwhelmed by the options available to them, prompting anxiety over their selections.

Understanding the Process

Students have until May 1 to decide on a college unless admitted through a binding plan. The spring brings a time for evaluating options and comparing choices. Students should view this process as a privilege rather than a burden, realizing the opportunity for growth and connection with their future peers.

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Expectations from Colleges

After acceptance, communication from colleges increases significantly. Students can expect invitations to events that allow them to interact with faculty, current students, and alumni, giving them a feel for campus culture and support systems.

Celebrating Achievements

Every acceptance should be celebrated, no matter the scale, as they reflect the hard work put into the application process.

Evaluating Options

Visits to campuses should focus on critical questions regarding fit and comfort. Students should actively engage during these visits to gauge community support, academic

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Chapter 10 Summary : Closing Letters

CHAPTER 10 Closing Letters

Homework for Students

The college admission process is fundamentally a journey of self-discovery and a reflection of personal values. Brennan offers two non-graded assignments:

1. An activity focused on expressing love and gratitude to family, framing this expression as essential to the college admission experience.
2. Suggested reading for deeper understanding, including summaries and key takeaways from influential books.

Do This

Brennan shares a personal story about his mother's struggle with Alzheimer's to emphasize the importance of expressing love and appreciation. He encourages students to voice their gratitude to their parents, reinforcing the value of relationships during the college admission journey.

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Read This

Brennan recommends the following books to aid in personal growth and understanding of the college search process, along with concise summaries and key messages:

1.

Start with Why by Simon Sinek

-

Synopsis

: Focuses on understanding the reasons behind actions, emphasizing the importance of articulating one's "why."

-

Key Quote

: “Knowing your WHY is... the only way to maintain lasting success.”

-

Take-Home

: Reflection on personal motivations is essential throughout the college application process.

2.

Where You Go Is Not Who You'll Be by Frank Bruni

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-

Synopsis

: Argues against the belief that attending a prestigious college guarantees success.

-

Key Quote

: "...the nature of a student's college experience... matters more than the name of the institution attended."

-

Take-Home

: Focus on engagement and the journey rather than just the institution.

3.

The Road to Character by David Brooks

-

Synopsis

: Explores the importance of character over achievements, distinguishing between "eulogy virtues" and "résumé virtues."

-

Key Quote

: "Self-respect is produced by inner triumphs, not external

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ones.”

-

Take-Home

: College admission should prioritize personal growth and values over mere academic credentials.

If You Remember Anything

Brennan emphasizes key points to carry forward regarding college admission:

- It is a personal journey focusing on identity and purpose.
- Engagement and enjoyment are vital; avoid making the process feel like a chore.
- College admission is not a definitive judgment of worth, nor is it uniform for all students.

Keeping It Simple: Advice for Parents

Rick shares valuable advice drawn from personal experience regarding parenting throughout the college admission process:

-

Change Your Filter

: Approach colleges with an open mind, forgetting outdated

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perceptions.

-

Practical Financial Discussions

: Openly discuss finances early with children to help them navigate costs and choices realistically.

-

Support and Objectivity

: Encourage students by detaching from personal biases towards their alma maters, allowing them to explore diverse options.

-

Control What You Can Control

: Focus on fostering a positive environment, avoiding harmful comparisons, and supporting kids emotionally and academically.

Concluding Insights

The college admission journey can be complex, but it is essential to love and support children throughout the process. Families should stay united, prioritize open communication, and cherish the relationships that matter most.

Ultimately, both students and parents are encouraged to embrace the journey with confidence, positivity, and a focus

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on personal growth, reinforcing that success can be found beyond elite institutions.

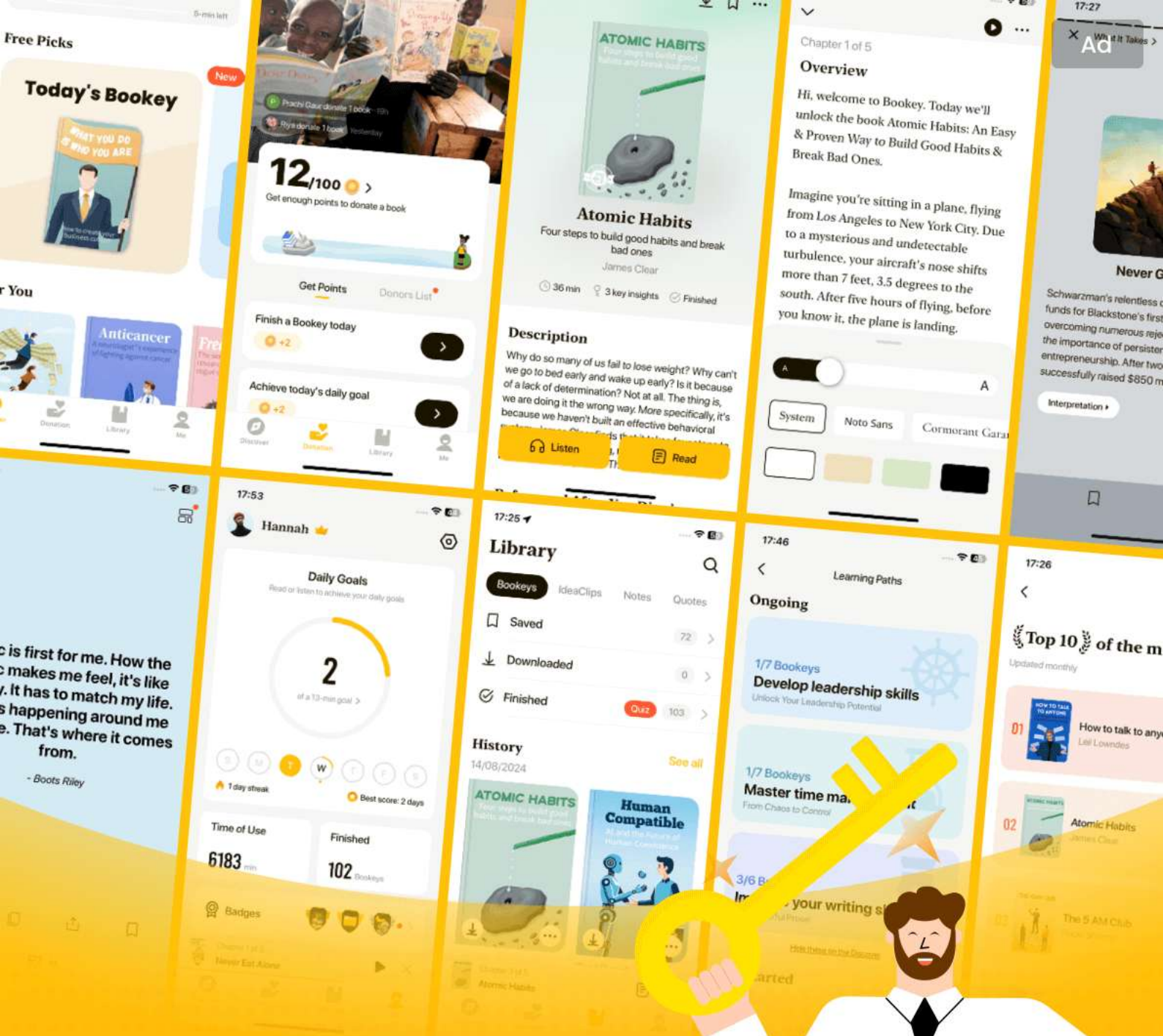
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Best Quotes from The Truth about College Admission by Brennan E Barnard with Page Numbers

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Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 35-59

- 1.The reality was that numerically we had admitted some students with lower scores or lower grades or less involvement.
- 2.You cannot answer ‘Where are you going to college?’ until you first answer ‘Why are you going?’
- 3.Your goal and vision cannot be which campus you will walk onto but how you will walk through the admission experience—together.
- 4.The admission experience is deeply and uniquely personal and relational.
- 5.If that piece is not set correctly, the integrity of the entire building is compromised.

Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 60-85

- 1.Look beyond what you see!

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- 2.The prospect of a college education should be filled with possibility, hope, and joy—and so should the experience to get there.
- 3.When counselors and admission officers talk to you about ‘finding the right fit,’ this is what they’re talking about. Getting into college is not an end unto itself; it’s not a ‘skins game’ of seeing how many colleges you can get accepted to. It’s about taking your first steps as an adult, and laying the foundation for the rest of your life.
- 4.Too many students and families have a myopic or simply dated view of the higher education landscape.
- 5.You’ll be amazed at the possibilities, and you’ll discover some hope and joy along the way.
- 6.—your job is to keep that perspective. Do your job! You have lots of options and choices.

Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 86-126

- 1.Let your application sit for a week and then come back with fresh eyes.
- 2.The time your parents make, the questions they ask, their

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desire to see things taken care of—these are absolutely grounded in deep affection.

- 3.If you will isolate this time (and cancel it in weeks you do not need to meet), you will help bolster family unity and ensure that your relationship does not unnecessarily narrow to a focus solely on college.
- 4.The communication wedge is real but avoidable.
- 5.Trust us—they need to hear it. (1) Thank you. (2) I love you.

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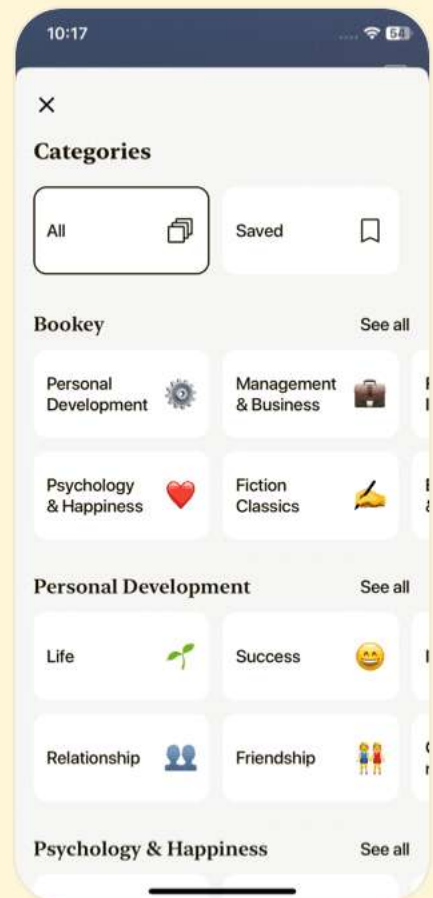
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Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 129-154

1. Keep an open mind that this is an opportunity to learn more about your child's true interests and deeper desires.
2. Too many families view the college search and admission experience as a plane ride.
3. Your job is to solicit as many opinions as possible and look for trends and commonalities while staying connected to your needs.
4. The ideal approach to building a college list is to focus on values, programs, and the experience.
5. Identify your needs in a college versus your wants.
Identifying your needs in a college versus your wants is critical.
6. Each year students tell us that they were counseled to only apply to schools ranked in U.S. News and World Report's Top 25... This mentality limits a healthy and comprehensive college search.
7. Your job is to keep an open mind—a mix of idealism and

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realism.

8. Remember, it is your list, your choice, your college experience.

Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 155-179

1. I hope you never fear those mountains in the distance / Never settle for the path of least resistance / Livin' might mean takin' chances, but they're worth takin'.
2. Trust your gut and you'll know the moment when it's the best place for you to thrive.
3. It is up to the student whether they are going to park their car passively or spend the year getting the most out of the driving experience.
4. Our hope is that you will look at this as an adventure; a time to explore, connect, and enjoy these experiences together.
5. Being a relentless inquirer is absolutely vital.
6. Your job is to dig and to clarify.
7. What makes this college different from other schools? This

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question is essential.

8.The journey is just as important as the destination.

9.Do your job!

Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 182-223

1.The college’s admission website says only two years of high school history/social studies required, so can I stop after US History junior year?

2.Has this student taken challenging classes and done well?

3.The point of course rigor is to prepare for a smooth transition to college and to prepare for more advanced coursework in college—not to use one’s course selections as a means of being admitted to the most selective college possible.

4.They conceal a fact that few outsiders realize: A low acceptance rate, along with high scores, grades and other characteristics, indicates inputs, not outputs.

5.It’s not just the level or rigor of classes you take that matters, but also the selections you make in given subject

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areas.

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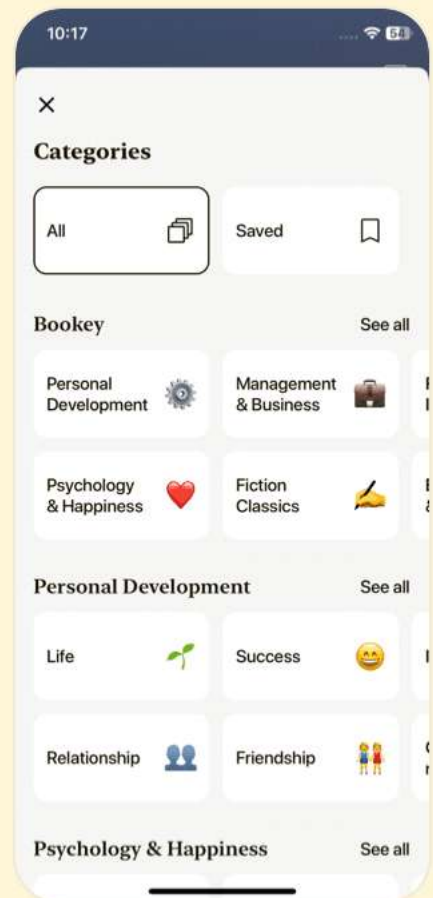
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Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 224-263

- 1.What Is This Student Involved with Outside the Classroom?
- 2.Pursue what you love to do in and out of high school, and make that clear on your application.
- 3.What Impact Has This Student Made?
- 4.Ultimately, admission reviewers are considering how you use your time outside the classroom because they know that being committed in high school translates to being an influencer during your college career and beyond.
- 5.The college application is your megaphone, so make sure your message is clear in your broadcast.

Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 264-299

- 1.Holistic review means it is a human process.
Human means subjective.
- 2.There is no perfect student or perfect school and most students would be successful at multiple institutions.
- 3.Emission decisions feel is not how they are made.
- 4.You may not get admitted... based on where you're from,

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what you want to study...this decision does not define you.

5.You are going to end up somewhere great.

6.Your goal is to have the confidence to embrace uncertainty as an adventure rather than a burden.

Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 302-332

1.May your choices reflect your hopes not your fears.

2.Once you make a decision, the universe conspires to make it happen.

3.You get to think through the place you are going to thrive and create a lifelong network.

4.Burn the ships!

5.You are making a decision for one year. You will make the best decision for yourself at this time with the information you have now.

6.Choosing a college is often more of an emotional decision as it is rational one.

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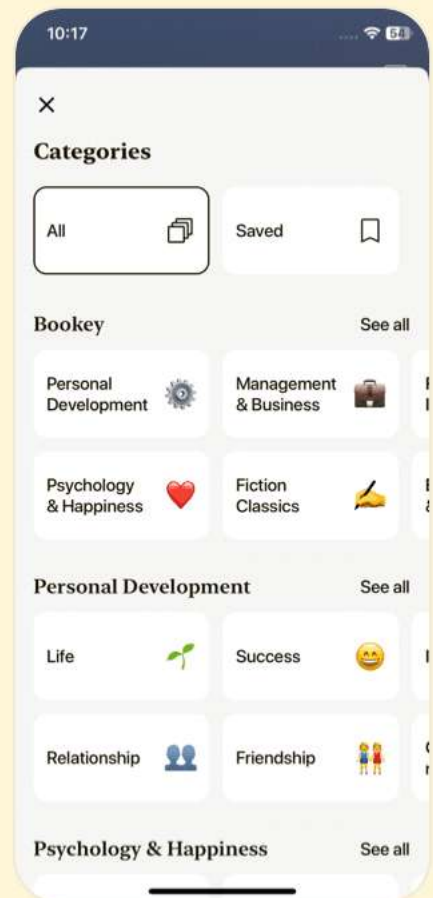
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Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 333-358

1. He who has a why to live for can bear almost any how.” —Friedrich Wilhelm Nietzsche
2. Knowing your WHY is not the only way to be successful, but it is the only way to maintain lasting success and have a greater blend of innovation and flexibility.
3. The nature of a student’s college experience—the work that he or she puts into it, the skills he or she picks up, the self-examination that’s undertaken, the resourcefulness that’s honed—matters more than the name of the institution attended.
4. Self-respect is produced by inner triumphs, not external ones.
5. College admission is a personal journey: this is your search, so own it.
6. Keep it simple—love your kids well.

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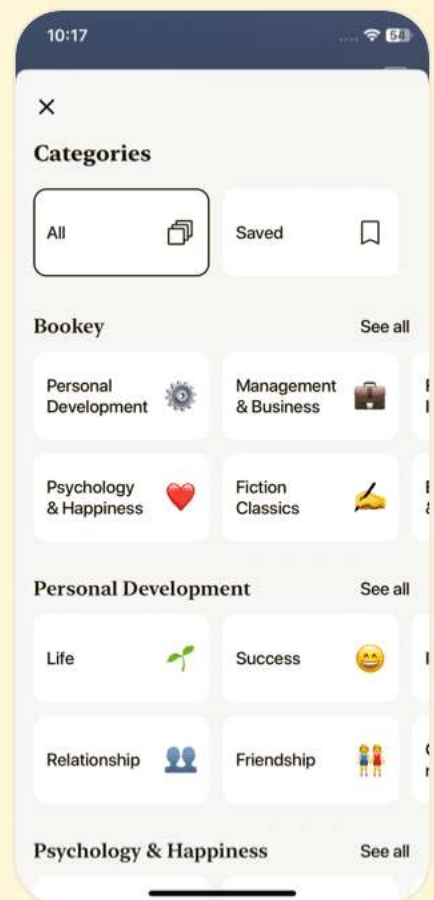
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Chapter 1 | Why Are You Going to College?| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important to ask 'Why are you going to college?' rather than 'Where do you want to go to college?'

Answer: Asking 'Why' gives depth and meaning to the college search process. It helps you understand your motivations, desires, and needs, laying the groundwork for making informed decisions about your education and future. Identifying your 'Why' allows for more meaningful conversations about your goals and aspirations, which leads to a more intentional and fulfilling college experience.

2.Question

Can you explain how the admissions process is different for each student?

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Answer: The college admissions process at selective institutions is highly individualized, with many factors affecting decisions, including personal backgrounds, geographic diversity, and institutional fit. No two applicants are evaluated on the same criteria, which means students with similar grades and test scores may have different experiences based on their unique attributes and experiences.

3.Question

What can families do to support one another during the college admissions process?

Answer: Families can support each other by maintaining open communication, sharing their thoughts and feelings about the college search, and encouraging each other to explore options. This support fosters connection and helps alleviate tension during a process that can create anxiety.

4.Question

What are some introspective questions students should ask themselves before applying to colleges?

Answer: Students should consider questions like: What do I

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hope to learn in college? What interests me? How do I envision my college experience shaping my future? Who do I want to meet? Where do I want to live? What challenges am I willing to face in this journey?

5.Question

How does understanding 'Why' affect how students choose schools?

Answer:Understanding 'Why' empowers students to make choices that align with their goals and values rather than choosing schools based merely on popularity or prestige. This introspection helps identify colleges that genuinely fit their aspirations and offers them the chance to thrive in environments that resonate with their personal ambitions.

6.Question

Why is the admission process considered a deeply personal experience?

Answer:The admission process is personal because it affects not just academic futures but also emotional and financial well-being. Families' hopes, dreams, and identities are

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intertwined with educational aspirations, which adds layers of complexity to decisions and outcomes.

7.Question

What should the focus be during the college admissions experience?

Answer:The focus should be on the journey rather than just the destination. It's about cultivating relationships, learning about oneself and others, and growing through the experiences of exploring potential colleges. Emphasizing family support and shared experiences will ultimately lead to a healthier and more enriching process.

8.Question

What is a common misconception about the college admissions process?

Answer:A common misconception is that there is a formula or guaranteed pathway to getting into selective colleges. The truth is that the process is dynamic, complex, and influenced by many subjective factors unique to each applicant.

9.Question

How does love play a role in the college admissions

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process from a parent's perspective?

Answer: Parents' love manifests in their involvement, concern, and emotional investment throughout the college search. Their actions, though sometimes perceived as overbearing, stem from a desire for their children's success, happiness, and future well-being.

10.Question

What does it mean to have a 'cornerstone question' in the context of this chapter?

Answer: A cornerstone question, such as 'Why are you going to college?', is essential for laying a strong foundation for the entire college search process. It requires deeper contemplation, guiding students to make thoughtful decisions that reflect their true ambitions and needs.

11.Question

What should students do when asked about their college plans?

Answer: Instead of feeling pressured to answer immediately, students can redirect the conversation to explore 'Why' they

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want to pursue higher education. This approach encourages meaningful dialogue and self-reflection.

Chapter 2 | Remapping the Admission Landscape| Q&A

1.Question

What is the importance of asking 'Why am I going to college?' before considering where to go?

Answer: This question helps reset your foundation for the college experience, guiding you to choose a school that aligns with your values, community, and learning preferences.

2.Question

How does the story about AJ's advice 'Look beyond what you see!' apply to the college search?

Answer: It serves as a reminder to maintain an open mind during the college search process, recognizing that numerous incredible options exist beyond initial perceptions.

3.Question

What is a key takeaway regarding the number of colleges and the admissions process?

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Answer: Most colleges are looking to admit good students, making the college admissions landscape more accessible than many families realize.

4. Question

How should students approach their initial college list?

Answer: Students should start broad in their search, considering various options rather than limiting themselves to a few well-known schools.

5. Question

What does 'working the funnel' mean in the context of college admissions?

Answer: It means actively engaging with colleges that show interest in you, which can enhance your chances of being invited to programs or receiving more detailed information.

6. Question

What challenges might students face in keeping an open mind during the college search?

Answer: Students might face societal pressure or preconceived notions about what the 'right' school looks like, which can narrow their perspective.

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7.Question

What advice is given about managing college recruitment materials?

Answer:Create designated boxes for sorting materials: one for schools you are considering, another for those that might be of interest to others, and a third for recycling to avoid clutter.

8.Question

After reading this chapter, how might one's perspective on college choices change?

Answer:Students may recognize the vast array of options available and consider schools they previously overlooked, enriching their search experience.

9.Question

What role does the college search process play in preparing for adulthood?

Answer:It lays the foundational steps for adulthood, emphasizing the importance of selecting a college based on personal fit rather than merely on prestige or popularity.

10.Question

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What does the 'Zoom' metaphor signify in the context of the college search?

Answer: It illustrates the need to take a step back and view the broader landscape of college options, rather than getting stuck in a narrow view.

Chapter 3 | Wedges of College Admission| Q&A

1.Question

What is a significant parallel between home buying and college admission?

Answer: Both processes can be overwhelming and stressful. Families find themselves bombarded with information, opinions, and competing priorities as they navigate their decisions. This can lead to significant tension within family dynamics.

2.Question

How can families manage the stress of college conversations?

Answer: Implement a weekly dedicated time for college discussions. This approach fosters unity and ensures that

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conversations about college don't dominate every family interaction.

3.Question

What should students do to engage with their parents during the college admission process?

Answer:Students should actively participate in discussions by bringing ideas, questions, and updates about their admission process. They should be ready to engage thoughtfully and avoid distractions like phones.

4.Question

What are parents encouraged to do regarding their expectations of their child's college options?

Answer:Parents should avoid comparing their child's options to their own past choices or peers'. Instead, they should focus on supporting their child's interests and aspirations.

5.Question

How should families address the financial aspect of college admissions?

Answer:Families should have open discussions about finances early in the process. This includes understanding

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costs, potential student contributions, and how to balance affordability with educational aspirations.

6.Question

What is the importance of using net price calculators in college planning?

Answer:Net price calculators help families gain a realistic perspective of what they will actually pay after financial aid, avoiding shock during the financial aid process.

7.Question

How can ego and pride become barriers during the college admission process?

Answer:Ego can lead both students and parents to make decisions based on societal status or prestige rather than personal fit. This can create divisions and hinder effective communication.

8.Question

What should parents do when their child faces college admissions disappointments?

Answer:Parents should support their child without placing blame or making the outcome a reflection of their parenting.

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Focus on celebrating achievements and maintaining a supportive relationship.

9.Question

How important is communication during the college admission process?

Answer:Communication is crucial to ensure all family members feel heard, valued, and understood throughout the often stressful and emotional admission process.

10.Question

What final piece of advice is given for maintaining family unity during the college admission process?

Answer:Prioritize expressions of love and gratitude regularly. Simple phrases like 'I trust you' and 'I am proud of you' can strengthen bonds and reduce tensions.

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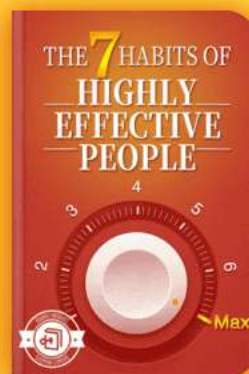
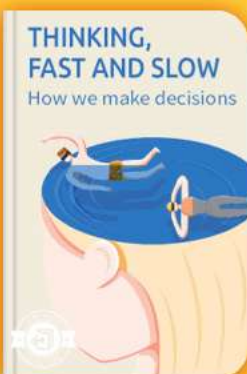


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Chapter 4 | Creating a College List| Q&A

1.Question

What mindset should families adopt during the college search process?

Answer:Families should view the college search and admission process as an exploratory tour rather than a direct flight to a single destination. This mindset encourages open-mindedness, adaptability, and a focus on learning rather than just rapid results.

2.Question

How can parents support their children during high school in terms of college preparation?

Answer:Parents should encourage their children to engage in activities they genuinely enjoy and to explore their interests without the pressure of building a college resume. Supporting their child in asking themselves what they are passionate about and helping them find opportunities to explore those interests is crucial.

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3.Question

What critical questions should students reflect on in high school?

Answer:Students should consider questions such as: What interests me? What do I enjoy doing in my free time? What subjects do I like? What kind of environment do I thrive in? Who do I enjoy spending time with? What professions seem appealing to me?

4.Question

What is the significance of the 'Celery Test' mentioned in the chapter?

Answer:The 'Celery Test' illustrates the importance of understanding your needs versus wants. Just like choosing healthier options at the grocery store when you know your dietary goals, students should approach college choices with a clear understanding of what they truly need from their education and experiences.

5.Question

How can students ensure a well-rounded college list?

Answer:Students should create a college list that includes a

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mix of reach, target, and likely schools. This variety provides options and maximizes the chances of acceptance while ensuring that all schools align with their personal interests and values.

6.Question

What role does college culture play in the selection process?

Answer:Understanding the culture of a college is crucial as it directly impacts the social and academic experience. Students should seek institutions whose environments resonate with their personal values and expectations for community engagement, diversity, and extracurricular opportunities.

7.Question

How can students research colleges effectively?

Answer:Research can be done through various platforms, college fairs, and campus visits. It's important to look beyond rankings and focus on how each school's offerings align with the student's goals and interests.

8.Question

What should students and parents communicate about

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their college preferences?

Answer: Both parties should discuss their expectations for college, including influencing factors like rankings, finances, and personal connections. Open dialogue can help clarify priorities and align their perspectives on college choices.

9.Question

Why is it important to maintain an evolving college list?

Answer: A college list should continuously evolve as students gain more insights about themselves and their preferences.

This dynamic process reflects growth and ensures that the final decisions align with their ever-changing interests and circumstances.

10.Question

What are the benefits of visiting college campuses as part of the search process?

Answer: Visiting campuses allows students to experience the environment, observe the student body, and gain firsthand insights that lead to informed decisions. It also helps in assessing if a school's culture and atmosphere are where they

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would thrive.

Chapter 5 | The College Visit| Q&A

1.Question

What are the benefits of visiting multiple colleges?

Answer: Visiting a wide variety of schools—large, small, urban, rural, private, public—helps you distinguish your needs and wants in a college. Just like test-driving a car before purchasing, experiencing campuses firsthand allows you to assess their environments, programs, and communities.

2.Question

When is the best time to visit colleges?

Answer: The ideal time to visit colleges is when school is in session, as you'll get the best feel for the campus culture. Weekday tours provide a livelier atmosphere compared to weekend visits, which may feel deserted.

3.Question

What questions should I ask during a college visit?

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Answer: Essential questions include: What is the campus culture like? What makes this college different from others? How accessible are professors? What are the graduation and retention rates, and what resources are available for academic support?

4.Question

How can I ensure I get a well-rounded perspective during campus tours?

Answer: Ask the same questions to a variety of people—students, faculty, and staff—to gather different insights. Consider their varying experiences to develop a balanced view of the college.

5.Question

Why is it important to connect with current students during college visits?

Answer: Current students provide authentic insights about campus life that admission guides may not reveal. Engaging with them allows you to gain a clearer picture of what it's like to be a student at that institution.

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6.Question

What should I do if I am unsure about the school after a visit?

Answer:Reflect on what aspects did not meet your expectations and why. It's important to trust your feelings about a campus, and if you feel a mismatch, that could indicate it's not the right fit.

7.Question

What role does asking questions play in the college visit experience?

Answer:Being a relentless inquirer during visits is vital; it helps you gain deeper understanding and tackle any uncertainties you have about the institution, beyond what is presented in tours and brochures.

8.Question

What actions can I take after the visit to reinforce my impressions?

Answer:Make notes about your experiences and reactions right after each visit to capture initial thoughts. Reflect on how each school aligns with your own values and desired

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college experience.

9.Question

How can I make the college visit memorable and meaningful?

Answer:Engage in scavenger hunts or challenges related to the visit, explore the surrounding town, and try to create shared experiences with family members to make the visits enjoyable and less stressful.

10.Question

What is the importance of 'demonstrated interest' during college admissions?

Answer:Demonstrated interest shows colleges that you are informed and genuinely interested in attending, which can positively influence your chances of admission.

Chapter 6 | Admission Factors I: What Are Colleges Looking for Academically?| Q&A

1.Question

What are the three primary means of submitting a college application?

Answer:The three primary means of submitting a

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college application are: institutional-specific applications, the Common Application, and the Coalition for College application.

2.Question

Why do colleges want to see students choose rigorous courses in high school?

Answer:Colleges want to see students choose rigorous courses because it demonstrates their desire to challenge themselves and indicates that they are prepared for the rigorous academic environment of college.

3.Question

What is the difference between Early Decision and Early Action?

Answer:Early Decision is a binding agreement where a student commits to attending a school if admitted, while Early Action is nonbinding, allowing students to apply early and receive decisions without committing to attend.

4.Question

What does a college admission committee mean by a 'holistic review'?

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Answer: A holistic review means that colleges consider not only academic scores but also personal attributes, achievements, and context, evaluating all aspects of an applicant's profile.

5.Question

How do colleges determine if a student has taken challenging classes?

Answer: Colleges refer to the student's school profile which outlines the curriculum options available and systematically assess the difficulty and rigor of the courses a student has chosen.

6.Question

What should students consider when preparing for standardized tests?

Answer: Students should consider their scores relative to the schools they are applying to, and plan their test preparation effectively, knowing that high scores can enhance their candidacy.

7.Question

How should students approach course selection to

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prepare for college?

Answer: Students should aim for a balance of challenging courses, ensuring they demonstrate consistent progress and effort across core subjects while avoiding a strategy of coasting through senior year.

8.Question

What is a 'formulaic admission review'?

Answer: Formulaic admission review is used by public universities where admissions are primarily determined by a straightforward evaluation of GPA, standardized test scores, and specific coursework, using established thresholds for acceptance.

9.Question

Why is it important for students to understand the selectivity of colleges?

Answer: Understanding selectivity helps students realistically assess their candidacy and avoid mistakenly correlating a college's quality solely with its acceptance rates.

10.Question

What does the term 'superscoring' mean in context to

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standardized testing?

Answer: Superscoring refers to the practice of combining the highest subsection scores from multiple test administrations to create a composite score, allowing students to showcase their best performances.

11.Question

What advice do colleges offer regarding applying to multiple colleges?

Answer: Colleges advise students to apply using the application method that meets their needs most effectively and to pay attention to each institution's specific application requirements.

12.Question

What is the key takeaway for students regarding college admissions and their application?

Answer: Students should focus on presenting a well-rounded application that highlights their academic achievements, rigorous course selection, and personal qualities, rather than fixating on test scores and acceptance rates.

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Chapter 7 | Admission Factors II: What Are Colleges Looking for Outside the Classroom?| Q&A

1.Question

What are the key nonacademic factors that colleges look for in applicants?

Answer:Colleges focus on extracurricular involvement, community contributions, the level of impact a student has made, and how they have influenced others. They want to see commitment to a few activities rather than a long list of superficial involvement.

2.Question

How should students approach their involvement outside the classroom in high school?

Answer:Students should pursue activities they are passionate about, not just to fill a resume. Quality of involvement and depth of commitment are more important than trying to be well-rounded.

3.Question

What advice does the chapter give regarding the

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importance of impact in extracurricular activities?

Answer: The chapter stresses that students should not only participate but also demonstrate significant impact.

Admission committees favor those who show leadership, commitment, and make a recognizable contribution to their communities.

4.Question

How can students articulate their extracurricular experiences effectively on their application?

Answer: Students should make a list of their activities, the time commitment, and the reasons behind their involvement. This preparation allows them to tell a cohesive story about their high school experience.

5.Question

Why are college essays crucial in the admission process?

Answer: Essays provide a unique opportunity to convey personality, values, and motivations in a way that other application components do not. They help distinguish applicants who may otherwise seem similar on paper.

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6.Question

What should students do if they face a blank screen when writing their college essay?

Answer:Instead of focusing on writing prompts, they should first reflect on their own experiences and feelings. Writing from a place of authenticity and personal insight allows for a more compelling narrative.

7.Question

What role do interviews play in college admissions?

Answer:Interviews allow colleges to gauge a student's communication skills, personality, and fit for the campus culture. They are an opportunity for students to showcase their interests and motivations directly.

8.Question

What are some practical tips for succeeding in college interviews?

Answer:Prepare thoroughly, research the college, be ready to discuss your motivations and contributions, dress appropriately, and follow up with a thank-you note to the interviewer.

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9.Question

How important are letters of recommendation in the college admissions process?

Answer:They provide insight into a student's character, contributions, and potential, reinforcing claims made in the application. Colleges prefer genuine, authentic recommendations over generic praise.

10.Question

How should students select teachers for their letters of recommendation?

Answer:Students should seek teachers who know them well and can speak to specific traits or growth, rather than just those with whom they achieved high grades.

11.Question

What is the significance of the 'Additional Information' section in applications?

Answer:This section allows students to explain any significant life events or challenges that impacted their academic journey, providing context that aids in the review process.

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12.Question

What overall message does the chapter convey about college admissions?

Answer:Admissions is holistic; it's about showing your authenticity, impact, and the unique contributions you can make to a college community.

Chapter 8 | Admission Decisions| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important to understand the principles of college admission decisions?

Answer:Understanding these principles helps students and families navigate the college application process with realistic expectations. It reveals that admission decisions are influenced by the supply and demand for spots in each institution, along with the specific missions guiding each college.

2.Question

What is the significance of a holistic review process in college admissions?

Answer:A holistic review reflects that admissions are

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subjective and made by humans, introducing elements of inconsistency and unpredictability. It emphasizes the importance of each applicant's personal background and experiences beyond just grades and test scores.

3.Question

How should students respond to being deferred in the admissions process?

Answer:Students should use the deferral to focus on maintaining strong grades and to demonstrate continued interest by possibly submitting additional materials, while also applying to other schools to ensure they have options.

4.Question

What does it mean if a student is placed on a waitlist?

Answer:Being waitlisted means the student is in limbo; it's an acknowledgment of their potential but reflects the need for the college to assess their admitted class size and demographic needs further before making additional offers.

5.Question

What should a student do if they receive a denial letter from a college?

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Answer:First, it's important to process the emotions of disappointment. Students should recognize that rejection does not reflect their worth or future success. They should refocus on other applications and schools that fit their aspirations better.

6.Question

What advice is given for celebrating an admission acceptance?

Answer:Celebrate the achievement with humility and gratitude, and remain aware that other qualified applicants may not have been accepted. It's essential to acknowledge the efforts that led to this acceptance and to read the acceptance letter carefully for any important conditions.

7.Question

How can families prepare for the emotional rollercoaster of college admissions decisions?

Answer:Families should have open discussions about the realities of admissions, preparing their students for various outcomes (acceptance, deferral, waitlisting, or denial) and

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reinforcing that these decisions do not define their self-worth or potential.

8.Question

What can be learned from the Olympic example of Gabby Douglas in the chapter?

Answer: Gabby's situation illustrates that even top performers can face unexpected outcomes due to competition rules and subjective judgments. It teaches resilience in the face of disappointment and reinforces the idea that many factors shape competitive environments.

9.Question

Why is it essential to understand each college's mission statement when applying?

Answer: Knowing the mission statements helps students align their applications with what the institution values, improving their chances of being viewed favorably by the admissions committee, as each school looks for candidates who fit their specific vision and goals.

10.Question

How should a student approach their senior year while

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navigating admission decisions?

Answer: Students should focus on doing well academically and personally, stay engaged with their communities, and maintain a positive outlook regardless of the admission decisions they face, understanding that their future success is not limited to a single college.

Chapter 9 | Making Your College Choice| Q&A

1.Question

What is the first step in making a college choice according to Brennan E Barnard?

Answer: Recognize that making a decision is a privilege and a gift, not a burden. Shift your perspective from 'I have to decide' to 'I get to decide'.

2.Question

How should one prepare for the college decision-making process?

Answer: By actively comparing options, considering personal values, and being open to seeking information and asking

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questions during campus visits and communications with admissions representatives.

3.Question

What does 'Burn the ships' symbolize in the context of choosing a college?

Answer:It represents committing fully to your choice without looking back. Once you decide, embrace the decision wholeheartedly and discard the idea of exploring other options.

4.Question

What critical questions should students ask themselves when visiting potential colleges?

Answer:Consider if you feel comfortable, what the culture is like, what opportunities exist for personal growth, and how you will be supported in your academic and personal endeavors.

5.Question

How can students ensure they make a confident college choice?

Answer:By gathering various perspectives from current

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students, alumni, and faculty, and assessing how each school aligns with their personal aspirations and lifestyle preferences.

6.Question

What advice does the text give about dealing with financial aspects of college choices?

Answer:Be diligent in comparing financial aid packages, understanding the implications of loans and scholarships, and evaluating the true cost of attendance relative to future earnings.

7.Question

What mindset should students adopt when faced with multiple college acceptances?

Answer:Celebrate the hard work that led to these acceptances, appreciate the choices you have, and remember that you can always change your path if your initial choice doesn't fit.

8.Question

What is advised against when choosing a college according to the professionals quoted in the chapter?

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Answer: Avoid focusing solely on prestige or external perceptions. Instead, consider where you will thrive personally and academically.

9.Question

How should students approach the final decision deadline of May 1?

Answer: Treat it seriously, understanding the deadline is firm and crucial for securing their spot. Begin fully committing to their chosen school by taking necessary actions.

10.Question

What emotional aspect should be considered in the decision-making process?

Answer: Trust your intuition and feelings about each college. Reflect on what excites you and which environment feels right for your growth and comfort.

11.Question

What should students do if they feel overwhelmed in their decision-making?

Answer: Take the time to narrow down choices, reflect on their feelings about each option, and actively engage with

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their families and counselors to gain clarity.

12.Question

Why is it important to engage with the campus culture during visits?

Answer:Understanding the community and culture helps assess whether the college will be a good fit for personal values and lifestyle preferences.

13.Question

What is the ultimate goal in making a college choice according to the chapter?

Answer:To select a college where you can grow, thrive, and create a meaningful and fulfilling experience over the next four years.

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Chapter 10 | Closing Letters| Q&A

1.Question

What is the most important homework assignment proposed in Chapter 10 and why is it significant?

Answer:The most important homework assignment is to express love and appreciation to your parents.

This exercise is significant because it acknowledges the foundational role of relationships in the college admission process, and it emphasizes the importance of gratitude and communication. By doing this, students reinforce their support system, which is crucial as they navigate the challenges of applying to college.

2.Question

How does the chapter suggest students should approach learning about themselves through the college admission process?

Answer:Students should engage in self-reflection by asking themselves questions about their hopes, fears, and aspirations for the next chapter of their lives. This approach allows them

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to connect with their 'why', which helps make the college search an adventure rather than a stressful chore.

3.Question

What are some key take-home messages from Simon Sinek's 'Start with Why'?

Answer:The key take-home messages include the importance of understanding your motivations and intentions behind actions. Sinek emphasizes that knowing your 'why' fosters lasting success and inspires innovation. This message reiterates that the journey through college admission should be driven by a purposeful connection to personal goals.

4.Question

What does Frank Bruni's 'Where You Go Is Not Who You'll Be' teach about college admissions?

Answer:Bruni's book teaches that the experience gained during college, the work put in, and personal development are more crucial to success than the prestige of the college attended. This shifts the focus from anxiety over admissions to actively engaging with and making the most of one's

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college experience, no matter where it takes place.

5.Question

According to David Brooks in 'The Road to Character,' what qualities truly define a person?

Answer: Brooks distinguishes between 'résumé virtues' (skills and accomplishments) and 'eulogy virtues' (qualities recognized by others, such as kindness and compassion). He argues that character is defined by the moral choices we make and our contributions to others, rather than just our academic or professional achievements.

6.Question

What overarching theme does the author want readers to remember about the college admission journey?

Answer: The author emphasizes that college admission is a personal journey filled with choices, and it should be approached with an emphasis on relationships, identity, and self-discovery rather than merely as a series of tasks to complete. Success in this journey is rooted in staying true to oneself and fostering meaningful connections.

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7.Question

Why should parents 'change their filter' when advising their children on college choices?

Answer:Parents should 'change their filter' to avoid outdated perceptions about colleges and instead see them with fresh eyes. This means recognizing the evolving reputation, opportunities, and student support available at various institutions, and avoiding preconceived notions that could negatively impact the student's excitement and decisions.

8.Question

What advice is given regarding handling emotional reactions to college admissions?

Answer:Parents are advised to manage their emotions constructively, recognizing that feelings of anger or frustration often stem from love and concern for their child. It's important to support the child positively, to encourage them during difficult times, and to instill confidence that their worth is not determined by college admissions.

9.Question

What is the significance of the 'beach knowledge' concept

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mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: The 'beach knowledge' concept refers to the lasting lessons and insights students should carry forward from their college admission experience. This includes understanding that the journey is personal, inherently imperfect, a celebration of effort, and an investment in their future. It's about reflecting on what truly matters in life and education, beyond mere admissions outcomes.

10.Question

How does the author hope families will approach the college move-in day?

Answer: The author hopes families will arrive at move-in day as a united front, fully acknowledging the mix of emotions involved—joy, pride, and the bittersweet feeling of letting go. He emphasizes the importance of maintaining family bonds and continual support throughout the college experience.

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The Concept



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Earn 100 points



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Your learning not only brings knowledge but also allows you to earn points for charitable causes! For every 100 points you earn, a book will be donated to Africa.

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The Truth about College Admission Quiz and Test

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Chapter 1 | Why Are You Going to College?| Quiz and Test

- 1.College admissions decisions are based solely on academic metrics such as GPA and test scores.
- 2.The chapter emphasizes the importance of viewing the college search as a competition.
- 3.Understanding the 'why' of going to college encourages deeper introspection on personal goals and aspirations.

Chapter 2 | Remapping the Admission Landscape| Quiz and Test

- 1.Most colleges in the U.S. have open admissions for applicants, even late in the admissions cycle.
- 2.The college search process is primarily a one-way street where only students seek colleges.
- 3.Families should maintain a fixed perspective when considering college options to avoid confusion.

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Chapter 3 | Wedges of College Admission| Quiz and Test

1. Chapter 3 compares the college admission process to the home buying experience due to the stress and confusion associated with both.
2. Families should have open discussions about college applications in public to build trust and reduce anxiety.
3. Parents are encouraged to limit their discussions about finances regarding college costs, particularly tuition, to avoid introducing significant stress.

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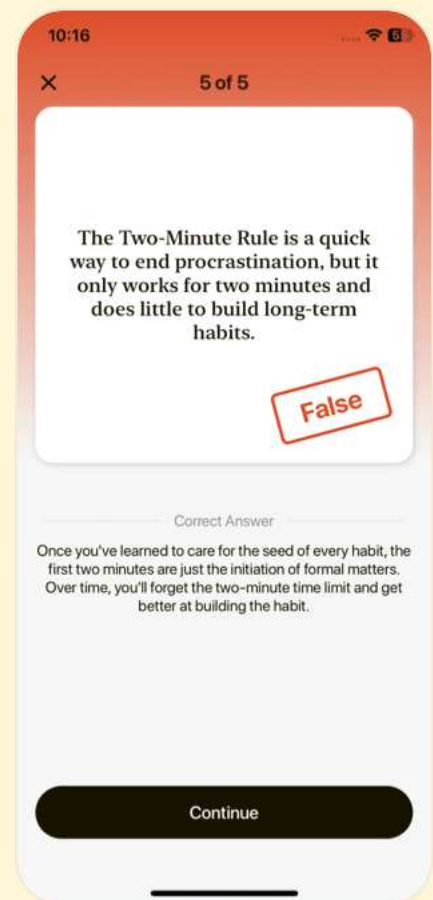
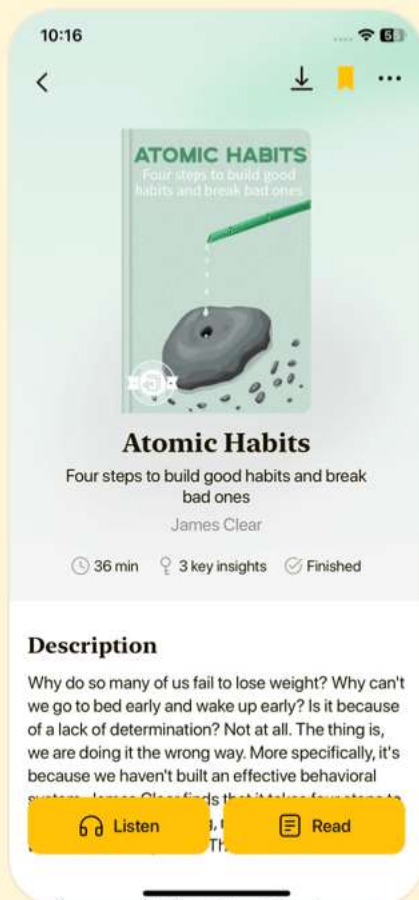


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Chapter 4 | Creating a College List| Quiz and Test

1. Creating a college list is primarily about reaching a specific destination rather than exploring interests.
2. Families can control about two-thirds of the college admission experience, including where to apply and attend.
3. In the freshman and sophomore years, students should focus heavily on college preparation under pressure.

Chapter 5 | The College Visit| Quiz and Test

1. Visiting colleges is essential because it helps students differentiate between their needs and wants.
2. It is best to visit colleges only during summer or holiday breaks to avoid interfering with school.
3. Transforming college visits into scavenger hunts can enhance the overall experience and retention of information.

Chapter 6 | Admission Factors I: What Are Colleges Looking for Academically?| Quiz and Test

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1. Students can submit college applications only through the Common Application.
2. Rolling Admission allows students to apply any time after the application opens, with decisions made upon receipt of applications.
3. Early Decision (ED) is a non-binding application option that allows students to apply to multiple colleges at once.

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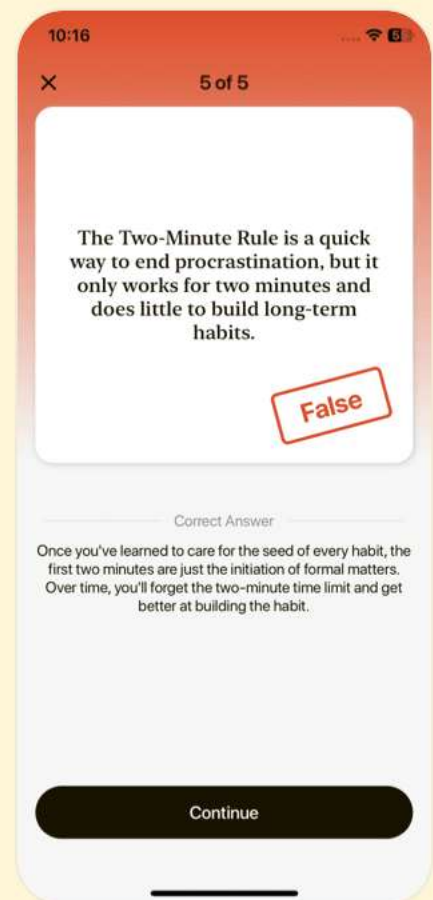
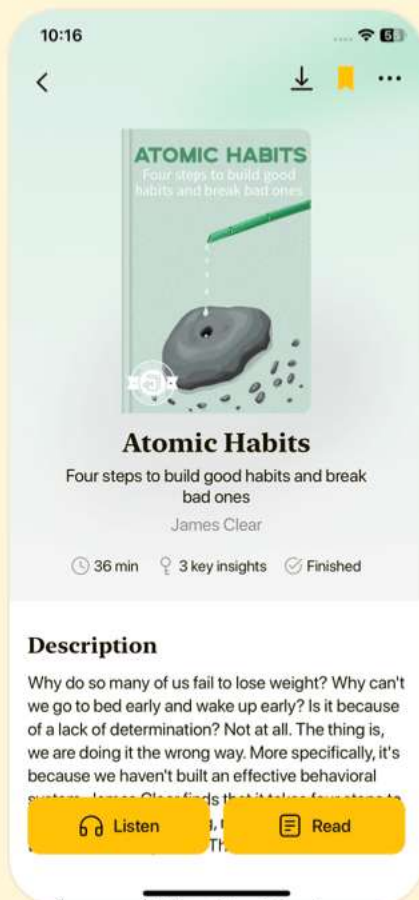


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Chapter 7 | Admission Factors II: What Are Colleges Looking for Outside the Classroom?| Quiz and Test

- 1.Colleges place equal importance on the volume of a student's extracurricular activities rather than the quality of involvement.
- 2.The impact a student has made through their extracurricular involvement is a crucial consideration for admission committees.
- 3.Essays should focus primarily on academic achievements to impress admission committees.

Chapter 8 | Admission Decisions| Quiz and Test

- 1.The holistic review process in college admissions is completely objective and fair.
- 2.Geographical considerations can influence admission outcomes, especially in state universities.
- 3.When a student is deferred, it means they have been denied admission to the college.

Chapter 9 | Making Your College Choice| Quiz and Test

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1. Students have until May 1 to decide on a college unless admitted through a binding plan.
2. Students should celebrate every acceptance, regardless of its scale, as it reflects their hard work.
3. Students should completely disregard financial packages when choosing a college.

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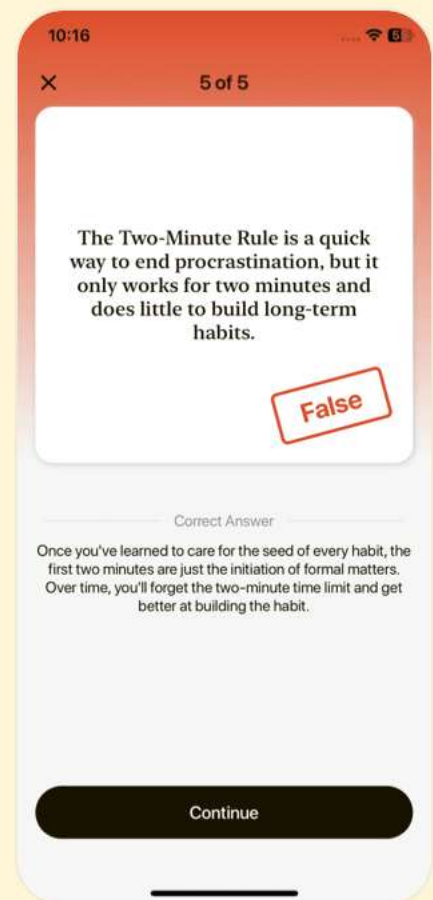
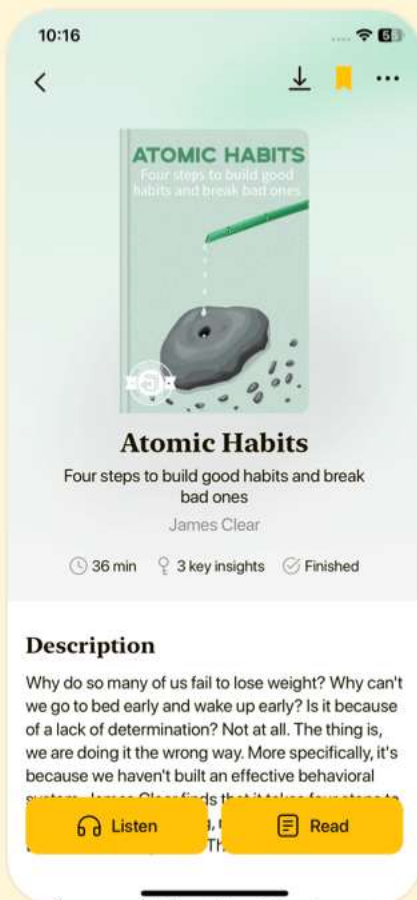


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Chapter 10 | Closing Letters| Quiz and Test

- 1.The college admission process is purely about academic achievements and resumes.
- 2.Brennan encourages students to express love and gratitude towards their family during the college admission process.
- 3.According to Brennan, attending a prestigious college guarantees future success.

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